THE PAWEN SUMMIT & AWARDS 2026

THE POWER SHIFT: AFRICAN WOMEN LEADING IN A TRANSFORMED WORLD

13–14 November 2026 | Lusaka, Zambia

3 Experiences

2 Days

1 Platform

DELEGATE INFORMATION PACK

Your guide to preparing for your trip, arriving confidently and making the most of your PAWEN 2026 experience.

WELCOME TO LUSAKA

We are delighted to welcome you to the PAWEN Summit, Exhibition & Awards 2026.

Over 2,000 delegates from 35+ countries and the diaspora will gather in Lusaka for conversations, learning, business connections and recognition of African women's leadership and achievements.

Whether you are attending as a professional, entrepreneur, executive, speaker, exhibitor or partner, this guide brings together the essential information you need before and during your stay.

PLEASE NOTE:

- The Summit is free but advance registration is compulsory.
- Exhibition space is paid.
- Awards Gala attendance requires a separate ticket.

EVENT AT A GLANCE

Summit & Exhibition

Friday 13 – Saturday 14 November 2026
Government Complex, Lusaka

Awards Gala

Saturday evening, 14 November 2026
InterContinental Hotel, Lusaka

Post-Event Experience

Sunday 15 November 2026
Victoria Falls Livingstone / Lusaka
(separate arrangements)

Airport

Kenneth Kaunda International Airport
(LUN)

Currency & Time

Zambian Kwacha (ZMW) /
Central Africa Time (UTC+2)

01 | Visas and travel documents

Visa requirements depend on your nationality and passport. Check Zambia's official guidance before making travel arrangements.

Check whether your nationality requires a visa
https://www.zambiaimmigration.gov.zm/nationals-who-dont-require-visa/

Option A | PAWEN-facilitated visa-on-arrival documentation

If you require a visa and wish to use PAWEN's facilitation process, complete the form below by Wednesday, 28 October 2026. This will be a Visa Approval Letter from Zambian Immigration Authorities that will enable eligible delegates to collect their visa on arrival. You will however need to pay for the visa upon arrival - $50

PAWEN Visa facilitation form

Option B | Apply directly online

Alternatively, you can submit your application through Zambia Immigration's official e-Services portal. Process is usually completed in approximately 2–5 working days. Apply as early as possible.

Apply for a visa online
https://eservices.zambiaimmigration.gov.zm/

Here is a step-by-step video on how to apply online.

When completing the online application, use the following PAWEN-specific details:

Visa type

Business Visa [Please do not select Tourist Visa, it will be denied]

Purpose of Visa

Attendance at the PAWEN Summit, Exhibition & Awards 2026, taking place from 13–14 November 2026 in Lusaka, Zambia.

Documents to prepare for the online application

- Passport-size photograph and a copy of your passport.
- An invitation letter from PAWEN.
- A certified copy of PAWEN's certificate of incorporation.
- A covering letter on company letterhead, addressed to the Director-General of Immigration, where required under the official Business Visa checklist.

Click here to download a Cover letter Template

To request the PAWEN invitation letter and certified certificate of incorporation, email **pawen2026@pawen.org**. The PAWEN team aims to respond the same day or next business day.

Official Business Visa documentation checklist

https://www.zambiaimmigration.gov.zm/for-visitors/visa-requirements-by-purpose-of-visit/

Before flying

- Confirm your passport has at least six months' validity on arrival and at least three full blank pages.
- Carry your return/onward ticket, accommodation address, event registration, and visa approval or facilitation paperwork where applicable.
- Check any visa fee and the requirements for collecting an endorsement on arrival.

02 | Travel, health and arrival

Health and insurance

Arrange travel and medical insurance.

Check yellow-fever certificate requirements for your departure and transit countries.

Seek travel-health advice about malaria prevention, vaccines and personal medication.

Bring essential medicine in original packaging and keep emergency contact information accessible.

Arriving at Kenneth Kaunda International Airport

- Lusaka's main airport is Kenneth Kaunda International Airport (LUN).
- Arrange a hotel transfer, airport taxi or verified ride-hailing trip to your accommodation. Check whether hotel transfers attract a separate fee.

Download transport apps before departure

We recommend installing Yango or inDrive before travelling. Uber is not available in Zambia.

Yango: https://yango.com/en_zm/city/lusaka/
inDrive https://indrive.com/

- Check your driver's name, number plate and car description before boarding.
- Share journey details with a trusted contact, particularly at night.
- Avoid unsolicited transport offers and allow extra time for Lusaka traffic.

If you would prefer a car hire service with a driver for the duration of your stay in Lusaka, send an email to pawen2026@pawen.org to get the list of vetted providers.

Your first three practical steps after arrival at the airport.

01

Buy a SIM

Visit an authorised mobile-network counter, at the Airport. Airtel, MTN and Zamtel operate in Zambia. You will need your passport for registration.

02

Set up mobile money

Explore if you are eligible for a mobile money wallet and how to activate it. Mobile money is commonly used for small purchases and some ride-hailing payments.

03

Add a small balance

Buy a data bundle and, if your wallet is active, add a modest mobile money balance. Also keep a little cash for transactions that cannot be paid digitally.

PLEASE NOTE Confirm accepted payment methods with your driver before your trip.

03 | Accommodation and local transport

PLAN YOUR STAY

Accommodation, arrivals and getting around Lusaka

Premium and mid-range accommodation

PAWEN has made delegate accommodation information and hotel discount arrangements available on the official Plan Your Trip page. Check the current property-specific terms and booking instructions there rather than relying on an old rate list.

Explore PAWEN delegate hotel discounts

Budget accommodation

For more economical accommodation, delegates can explore Airbnb listings or Natwange Backpackers. Check recent reviews, cancellation policies, travel time to the venue and security arrangements before booking.

Airbnb: www.airbnb.com

Natwange Backpackers: www.natwangebackpackers.com

PLEASE NOTE: Delegates are responsible for their accommodation and travel arrangements

Getting to the Summit and Exhibition

Venue: Government Complex, Lusaka | Friday 13 and Saturday 14 November 2026. Use a verified Yango or inDrive ride, or ask your hotel about a trusted taxi. Plan around morning and evening traffic.

Getting to the Awards Gala

Venue: InterContinental Hotel, Lusaka | Saturday evening, 14 November 2026. This is a different location from the Summit, so arrange separate transport and consult your Gala ticket for confirmed arrival timings.

Safety reminders

- Pre-book transport after dark and avoid walking alone at night.
- Keep passports and valuables secure; have a digital copy of key documents.
- Use recognised taxis, banks, ATMs and currency exchange providers.
- Wear a seat belt and keep your phone charged.

04 | Lusaka practical essentials

Currency

Zambian Kwacha (ZMW)

Language

English is the official language; Nyanja & Bemba are commonly spoken.

Time

Central Africa Time, UTC+2

Power

230V, 50Hz; Type G (Used in Kenya, Uganda, Nigeria and Malawi) sockets commonly used

Mobile networks

Airtel, MTN, Zamtel

Ride-hailing

Yango and inDrive; Uber is not available

Roads

Drive on the left

Money and payments

Larger hotels and restaurants commonly accept major cards. Mobile money and cash remain important for smaller transactions, transport and everyday payments. Carry some Zambian Kwacha and check any card charges or exchange rates before confirming a transaction.

Weather and packing

November is generally warm to hot, with possible rain. Pack breathable clothing, a compact umbrella or light rain jacket, comfortable shoes, sunscreen and insect repellent. A light layer may be useful in air-conditioned rooms.

What to wear

Summit and Exhibition

Smart business, business casual or elegant African attire. Choose comfortable shoes for moving between sessions and exhibition stands.

Awards Gala

African Inspired Black Tie event.
An elegant formal dress code celebrating African heritage and contemporary style. Guests are encouraged to wear evening gowns, sophisticated African-inspired dresses, tailored suits or tuxedos, complemented by African fabrics, prints, embroidery or statement accessories. The emphasis is on black-tie elegance with a distinctive African touch, rather than traditional attire alone.

Dining

Lusaka offers local and international food. For a local experience, consider nshima with vegetables, fish or meat at a reputable restaurant. Confirm any allergies or dietary requirements when ordering.

05 | Make the most of PAWEN 2026

The Summit is designed to turn insight and introductions into longer-term relationships, collaboration and new possibilities.

Before the event

- Review the latest programme and choose priority sessions.
- Explore the speakers and identify people you would like to meet.
- Update your LinkedIn profile and prepare a brief introduction.
- Have a digital business card or contact-sharing QR code ready.

Explore the speaker lineup

During the event

- Attend sessions that are relevant to your career, leadership or business goals.
- Visit the Exhibition and discover African enterprises, products and partners.
- Introduce yourself to fellow delegates, speakers and exhibitors.
- Capture useful follow-up actions immediately after important conversations.
- Share your event insights using #PAWEN2026 and #PAWENSUMMIT2026 #PAWENAWARDS2026

Experience Zambia

Delegates extending their stay can explore Lusaka or consider the optional Victoria Falls / Livingstone or Lusaka experience after the Awards Gala. Any transfers, accommodation or excursions are separate arrangements and will involve additional costs. Refer to the website **www.thepawenawards.org** for more information.

06 | Useful contacts and checklist

All Enquiries:

pawen2026@pawen.org

Police:

991

Ambulance:

992

Fire:

993

Before you travel

- Summit registration confirmed
- Passport and visa requirements checked
- Visa/ Visa Approval letter received
- Flight and accommodation booked
- Yango or inDrive downloaded
- SIM/mobile-money requirements reviewed
- Travel health and insurance checked
- Event venues and tickets saved
- Travel documents and emergency contacts accessible

We look forward to welcoming you to Lusaka.

Please recheck changing immigration, health, travel and booking requirements before departure.
This pack will be periodically updated so check **www.thepawenawards.org/dip** for updates